

planned very far ahead for that reason. Everybody wanted to see his money again as quickly as possible. This condition of affairs reached a climax in the "Bryan campaign" of 1896, when for a short time business men and financiers did the best they could towards suspending business altogether.

The election of McKinley in that year destroyed the principal fear that had so completely shaken people's confidence in the future. Mr. McKinley was elected in November of 1896, but it was not until the summer and fall of 1897 that the growth of confidence became really notable. This growth was very slow and very disappointing to people in Wall Street at that time. During the latter half of 1897, however, and practically all through 1898 confidence grew more and more rapidly, and in the first three months of 1899 it had become well grown. Then came a check to its growth from the "industrial collapse" and later from the "Boer War," and the effect of these had not passed away when the campaign of "1900" had to be faced.

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*There is a general similarity in all "booms" and in all periods of depression. The character of these movements is like a snowball running down an inclined plane and gathering snow as it runs.*

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Mr. McKinley's re-election in 1900, however, gave it renewed growth, and in the six months following his election, if the stock market be taken as a fair index, the "boom" made more progress than it had made in the preceding three years. It went on practically without a check till the "Northern Pacific corner" in May. That event resulted in a decline, temporary, it is true, but of a magnitude and severity surpassing anything recorded in the annals of Wall Street.

Some people ask why there should be a reaction from the boom of the last four years, seeing the growing prosperity of the country at this time. Those who believe that such reac-